

HS 210: Introduction to Poetry in English

Course Code	HS 210
Course Name	Introduction to Poetry in English
L-T-P-C	3-0-0-3
Prerequisites	-
Intended for	UG 2nd, 3rd and 4th years
Distribution	Elective
Mutual Exclusion	-
Approval	59th BoA (Apr 2025)

Course Contents

- **Introduction to Poetry** [8 Lectures]
 - Definition and characteristics of poetry
 - Brief history of poetry in the English language
 - Overview of literary movements and poetic forms and techniques
 - Interpreting and reading poetry (formalist, historical, biographical, psychoanalytic, feminist, structuralist, reader-response, scansion, ecocritical, postcolonial etc.)
 - Thematic approaches to poetry (including love and desire, identity and belonging, nature and environment, social and political issues, etc.)
- **Poetic Traditions and Practices Across Space and Time** [20 Lectures]
 - English Poetry (with selections from Old English to the Victorian Period)
 - American Poetry (with selections from the Early National to the Realist Period)
 - Poetry in English from Africa and Asia (with selections from the Colonial to the Postcolonial Era)
 - Poetry from Australia and New Zealand (with selections from the Early Colonial to the Postwar Era)
- **Modernist and Postmodernist Poetry** [8 Lectures]
 - The modernist movements and their impact on poetry
 - Key modernist figures and their work
 - Fragmentation, stream of consciousness, imagism, and philosophical influences on poetry
 - The role of parody, irony, and pastiche in postmodernist poetry
- **Contemporary Poetry** [6 Lectures]
 - Contemporary poetic trends and innovations, including slam poetry, digital poetry, and other experimental forms
 - Impact of globalization on poetry, translation and cultural exchange
 - Poetry on social media and the World Wide Web
 - Technology and AI in the creation, dissemination, and reception of poetry

Laboratory Modules

- Poetry recitations and performances, critical analysis workshops, and guest lectures by practising poets.

Text Books

1. **Norton Anthology of English Literature** (9th edition)
2. **The Oxford Book of English Verse** (edited by John Carey)
3. **Modern American Poetry** (edited by Robert Bly)
4. **The Oxford Anthology of Modern Indian Poetry** (edited by Vinay Dharwadker and A. K. Ramanujan)
5. **The Penguin Book of Postcolonial Poetry** (edited by Neil Astley)

References

1. **The Cambridge Companion to English Poetry** (edited by Stephen Greenblatt)
2. **The Oxford History of English Poetry** (edited by John Burrow)
3. **Poetry: A Critical Introduction** (by David Daiches)
4. **Global Poetics: A New Anthology of World Poetry** (edited by Charles Simic)
5. **A History of Indian Poetry in English** (edited by Rosinka Chaudhuri)
6. **Postcolonial Poetry in English** (by Rajeev S. Patke)
7. **The Anxiety of Influence: A Theory of Poetry** (by Harold Bloom)